

Supplemental 14th Amendment Case Law Analysis

MTUS Constitutional Analysis Project
Personal Research Initiative
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Supplemental 14th Amendment Case Law Analysis

For MTUS Constitutional Challenge

RESEARCH NOTE: This document presents potentially relevant case law for educational and analytical purposes. Inclusion of a case does not guarantee it applies to the MTUS situation. This is legal research, not legal advice.

I. SUSPECT CLASSIFICATION CASES

1. **Brown v. Board of Education (1954) 347 U.S. 483**

Holding: Racial segregation in public schools violates Equal Protection.

Potential Application to MTUS:

- While race-based, Brown established that "separate but equal" is inherently unequal
- MTUS creates separate treatment standards for workers' comp patients vs. all other patients
- Could analogize: Separate medical standards are inherently unequal when they produce inferior outcomes
- Limitation: Workers' comp status is not a suspect class like race

Better Fit: Demonstrates constitutional intolerance for dual-tier systems

2. **City of Cleburne v. Cleburne Living Center (1985) 473 U.S. 432**

Already cited in your brief - Good precedent for "irrational classification"

3. **Romer v. Evans (1996) 517 U.S. 620**

Holding: Colorado amendment denying LGBT people protection from discrimination violated Equal Protection (rational basis review).

Potential Application:

- Law singled out one group for disfavored treatment
- Court found no rational basis for animus-based classification
- MTUS singles out workers' comp patients for disfavored medical treatment
- Key quote: "A law declaring that in general it shall be more difficult for one group of citizens than for all others to seek aid from the government is itself a denial of equal protection."

Strong analog to MTUS: Workers' comp patients face more difficult path to medical care

II. FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS / MEDICAL CARE CASES

4. *Estelle v. Gamble* (1976) 429 U.S. 97

Already cited - Prisoner medical care, deliberate indifference standard

5. *Youngberg v. Romeo* (1982) 457 U.S. 307

Holding: Institutionalized mentally disabled persons have liberty interest in safety and freedom from bodily restraint, including adequate food, shelter, clothing, and medical care.

Potential Application:

- Establishes constitutional right to medical care for vulnerable, state-dependent populations
 - Injured workers are state-dependent (must use workers' comp system)
 - State cannot be deliberately indifferent to serious medical needs
 - Strong precedent for fundamental right to medical care when state has assumed duty
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6. *DeShaney v. Winnebago County* (1989) 489 U.S. 189

Holding: State generally has no duty to protect individuals from private harm unless state has created special relationship.

Counter-point to MTUS argument:

- State has no general duty to provide medical care
- BUT: Distinguishable - California HAS created special relationship via workers' comp statute
- State assumed duty to provide medical care through Labor Code 4600
- Creates the "special relationship" DeShaney requires

Use strategically: Acknowledge then distinguish

III. RATIONAL BASIS FAILURES

7. *U.S. Department of Agriculture v. Moreno* (1973) 413 U.S. 528

Holding: Law denying food stamps to households containing unrelated persons had no rational basis; appeared

motivated by bare congressional desire to harm "hippies."

Potential Application:

- Court struck down classification that seemed designed to harm disfavored group
- MTUS classification may appear designed to reduce costs at expense of injured workers
- Key quote: "[T]he challenged classification... cannot be deemed rationally related to a legitimate governmental interest."

Strong precedent for irrational classification targeting vulnerable group

8. City of Los Angeles v. Manheimer (1976) - wait, check this

Actually: Village of Willowbrook v. Olech (2000) 528 U.S. 562

Holding: Equal Protection
fundamental right.

Potential Application:

- "Class of one" theory - treating similarly situated person differently without rational basis violates Equal Protection
 - Each injured worker denied FDA-approved treatment is a "class of one" treated differently from non-workers' comp patients
 - Very strong precedent for MTUS
-

9. Williams v. Pryor (2000) - actually Williams v. Alabama (2019)? Let me use:

Fitzgerald v. Racing Association of Central Iowa (2003) - actually better:

9. Armour v. City of Indianapolis (2012) 566 U.S. 673

Holding: Administrative convenience can be rational basis for classification.

Counter-point to MTUS:

- State may argue MTUS is administrative convenience for cost control
 - Response: Administrative convenience cannot justify unconstitutional classification
 - Moreno and Romer trump administrative convenience
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IV. IRREBUTTABLE PRESUMPTION CASES

10. Vlandis v. Kline (1973) 412 U.S. 441

Holding: States may not impose irrebuttable presumptions that deny individuals opportunity to prove actual facts.

Already in your brief - Strong precedent

11. Cleveland Board of Education v. LaFleur (1974) 414 U.S. 632

Holding: Mandatory pregnancy leave policies based on irrebuttable presumptions of incapacity violate Due Process.

Potential Application:

- MTUS creates irrebuttable presumption: "Insufficient evidence" = automatic denial
 - No opportunity to prove FDA-approved treatment would help individual patient
 - Strong analog
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12. Stanley v. Illinois (1972) 405 U.S. 645

Holding: Presumption that unwed fathers are unfit parents violates Due Process.

Potential Application:

- MTUS presumption: FDA-approved treatments are "not recommended" for workers
 - Presumption operates against interest of injured workers
 - Good supporting precedent
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V. DISCRIMINATORY IMPACT / DISPARATE IMPACT

13. Washington v. Davis (1976) 426 U.S. 229

Holding: Disparate impact alone does not violate Equal Protection; need proof of discriminatory purpose for strict scrutiny.

Counter-point to MTUS:

- Washington v. Davis requires proof of discriminatory intent for strict scrutiny
- MTUS argument uses rational basis, not strict scrutiny
- Your strategy: Don't need discriminatory intent for rational basis challenge
- Just need to show classification lacks rational relationship to legitimate purpose

Use strategically: Distinguish - you're arguing irrational classification, not racial discrimination

14. Personnel Administrator v. Feeney (1979) 442 U.S. 256

Holding: Discriminatory purpose means more than intent as volition or intent as awareness of consequences.

Potential Counter-argument:

- State may argue MTUS discriminatory effects are incidental, not purposeful
 - Response: Even if not purposefully discriminatory, classification is still irrational under rational basis
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VI. SPECIAL CASE: MEDICAL MARIJUANA / STATE EXPERIMENTATION

15. Gonzales v. Raich (2005) 545 U.S. 1

Holding: Federal Commerce Clause power overrides state medical marijuana laws.

Not directly relevant but shows federal courts do consider medical necessity arguments

VII. STRONGEST CASES FOR MTUS ARGUMENT

Tier 1 (Most Directly Applicable):

1. Romer v. Evans - Singling out group for disfavored treatment

2. Moreno - Classi

Tier 2 (Strong Supporting):

6. LaFleur - Irrebuttable presumptions violate Due Process

7. Vlandis - Same

Tier 3 (Contextual/Supporting):

10. Brown - Philosophical intolerance for separate-but-unequal

11. Romer languag

VIII. CASES TO DISTINGUISH (State Will Likely Cite)

1. Washington v. Davis (1976)

State argument: No discriminatory intent, therefore no Equal Protection violation.

Your response:

- Davis applies strict scrutiny requiring intent
 - MTUS challenge uses rational basis review
 - Under rational basis, don't need intent - just need to show classification is irrational
 - See Moreno, Romer (irrational classifications struck down without finding discriminatory intent)
-

2. DeShaney v. Winnebago County (1989)

State argument: No general duty to provide medical care.

Your response:

- DeShaney requires "special relationship" for state duty
 - California workers' comp statute creates special relationship
 - State assumed duty to provide medical care via Labor Code 4600
 - See Youngberg (state assumed duty creates constitutional obligation)
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3. Harris v. McRae (1980) 448 U.S. 297

Holding: Hyde Amendment (no federal funding for abortion) does not violate Due Process or Equal Protection.

State argument: State can choose what medical treatments to fund.

Your response:

- McRae involved abortion (controversial, not medically consensus)
 - MTUS involves FDA-approved treatments for work injuries (medically accepted)
 - State cannot deny medically necessary care to one class while providing to others
 - See Moreno (cannot single out group for disfavored treatment)
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IX. SYNTHESIS: WINNING ARGUMENT STRUCTURE

Primary Theory: Irrational Classification (Rational Basis)

Using: Romer, Moreno, Cleburne, Olech

Argument:

1. MTUS creates c

Secondary Theory: Irrebuttable Presumption

Using: Vlandis, LaFleur, Stanley

Argument:

1. MTUS "Insufficient

Tertiary Theory: Fundamental Right / State-Created Duty

Using: Youngberg, Estelle

Argument:

1. State assumed

X. BROWN V. BOARD SPECIFIC ANALYSIS

Direct Application: Weak (race vs. workers' comp status)

Philosophical Application: Strong

Use Brown for:

- Symbolic power of "separate but equal" being inherently unequal
- MTUS creates separate medical standard for workers' comp
- Philosophical argument: Dual-tier medical care is inherently unequal
- Limitation: Must acknowledge race is suspect class; workers' comp status is not
- Use in: Introduction/conclusion for emotional/philosophical impact
- Don't rely on: As binding precedent (distinguishable on facts)

Better doctrinal fit: Romer, Moreno, Olech

XI. RECOMMENDED CASES TO ADD TO BRIEF

Must Add:

1. Romer v. Evans (1996) - Singling out group for disfavored treatment

2. Village of Willow

Should Add:

4. Cleveland Board of Education v. LaFleur (1974) - Irrebuttable presumptions

5. U.S. Dept. of Ag

Optional (Philosophical):

7. Brown v. Board (1954) - Separate is inherently unequal (acknowledge limitations)

XII. CASES TO PREEMPTIVELY DISTINGUISH

Prepare responses to:

1. Washington v. D

CONCLUSION

The strongest precedents for MTUS challenge are:

1. Romer (singling

Brown v. Board has symbolic value but weak doctrinal fit due to race-based suspect classification.

Focus on rational basis precedents (Romer, Moreno, Olech) combined with irrebuttable presumption cases (Vlandis, LaFleur).

RESEARCH NOTE: This analysis is for educational purposes. Consult qualified constitutional counsel before

filing any legal challenge.

Last Updated: February 15, 2026

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